



1 Purpose of the Isartor Test Suite

Introduction

This is the documentation for the Isartor¹ (first sound is *Ee*, second syllable rhymes with *for*) test suite. This test suite comprises a set of files which can be used to check the conformance of software regarding the PDF/A-1 standard. More precisely, the Isartor test suite can be used to “validate the validators”: It deliberately violates the requirements of PDF/A-1 in a systematic way in order to check whether PDF/A-1 validation software actually finds the violations.

PDF/A-1 test files can be organized in four categories according to the following table:

Name of the test suite quadrant	Documents conform to PDF/A-1?	purpose
PDF/A-1b FAIL	no	deliberately violate all possible aspects of PDF/A-1 conformance, and check whether PDF/A-1 validation software correctly identifies the reasons for non-conformance
PDF/A-1a FAIL	no	
PDF/A-1b PASS	yes	create PDF/A-conforming documents with uncommon features or combinations of features and check whether PDF/A-1 validation software correctly identifies the documents as standard conforming
PDF/A-1a PASS	yes	

The present installment of the Isartor test suite implements the PDF/A-1b FAIL quadrant. It does not cover any of the other quadrants, although it is envisioned that future installments will expand quadrant coverage.

Basic Principles

The Isartor test suite has been constructed according to the following basic principles:

- Atomic: A test file attempts to examine a particular aspect of the standard. Wherever possible test files avoid to touch more than one aspect of the standard.

1. The Isartor test suite is named after the location of the first meeting of the TWG (see chapter 5, “Who created the Test Suite?”, page 10), a medieval gate towards the river Isar in the center of Munich/Germany, see for example www.munich-info.de/portrait/p_isartor_en.html.

